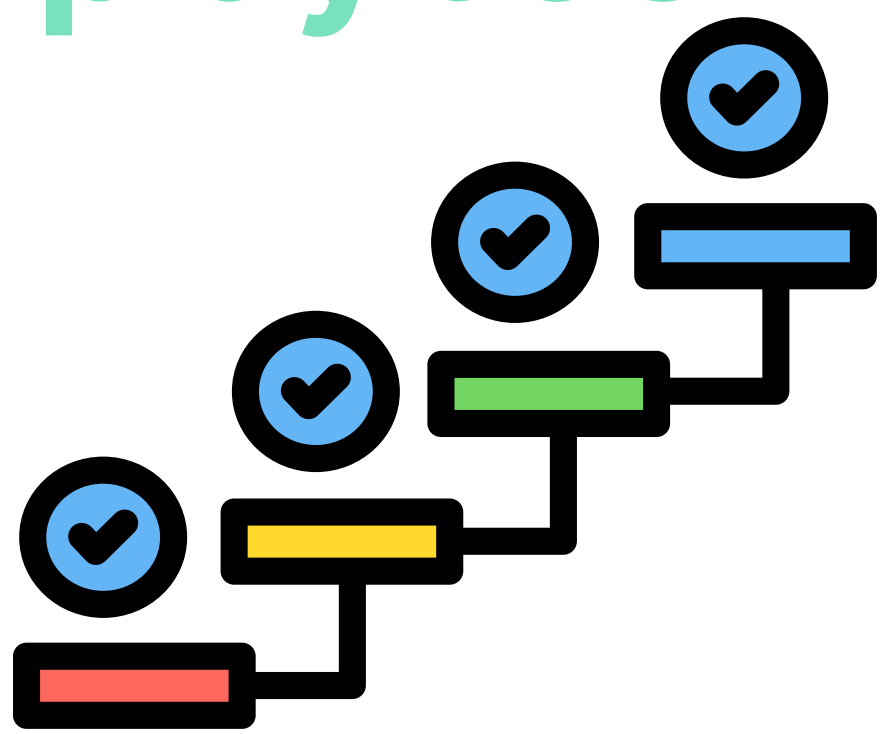
BUSINESS ANALYST: STARTING NEW PROJECT

Follow this **exact playbook**



Step 1: Establish Context

Why does this project exist	• What problem are we solving? • What triggered the initiative? • What does success look like? • What's explicitly in / out of scope?
Outcome:	shared understanding of why we're here
Deliverables	Problem Statement (or Project Context Summary)

Business Problem Statement Template

Project Name	Online Booking & Scheduling System Implementation
Project Sponsor	Sarah Lawson – Operations Manager
BA	Matthew Holliday - Lead BA

1. Background / Context

WorkWell Health is a single allied-health clinic in Brisbane offering physiotherapy, psychology, dietitian, and occupational-therapy services. The clinic has grown steadily in clients and practitioners over the past few years, but the way bookings are managed hasn't changed.

All appointments are handled manually through phone calls and emails. Administrators update a shared Excel file ("Bookings_2025.xlsx") and cross-check it against each practitioner's Outlook calendar. Intake forms are completed in Word and emailed around. Weekly activity and utilisation reports are created manually in Excel.

There is no automation, no integration, and no online booking option for clients. This way of working is now causing delays, workload issues, and booking errors as the clinic gets busier.

2. Problem Statement

The current manual booking process is inefficient, inconsistent, and no longer scalable.
Administrators spend a large amount of time maintaining spreadsheets, responding to calls, and emailing practitioners. Clients wait on hold or send emails that take time to respond to. Practitioners don't get real-time updates, and Operations has limited visibility of booking patterns, no-shows, or cancellations.

This impacts staff workload, client experience, operational reporting, and the clinic's ability to keep up with demand.

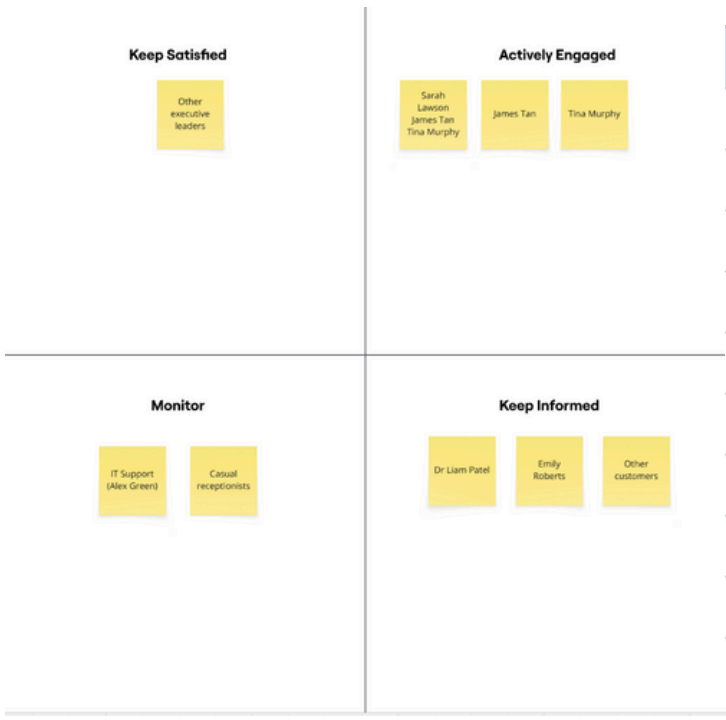
3. Evidence / Impact

- Administrators handle around 60 calls per day and spend 35+ hours a week updating the spreadsheet and sending emails.
- Double bookings and missed cancellations occur due to manual data entry.
- Practitioners receive outdated schedules, leading to confusion and gaps in their day.
- Clients have no way to book or manage appointments after hours.
- Reporting for the Operations Manager is manual, weekly, and often incomplete.
- Emailing intake forms and client details creates privacy and compliance risks.

These issues create rework, lost appointment opportunities, and inconsistent service for clients.

Step 2: Stakeholder Analysis

Who needs to be involved (and how)	• Business owners • Delivery teams • SMEs, risk, legal, ops • Vendors / third parties (if applicable)
Outcome:	clear ownership and decision paths
Deliverables	Stakeholder Map + Stakeholder Analysis



Stakeholder Name	Role / Title	Department	Email	Interest Lev (Low/Med/Hi
Sarah Lawson	Operations Manager (Sponsor)	Operations	sarah.lawson@workwellhealth.com	High
James Tan	Head of Digital Solutions (Product Owner)	Digital / IT	james.tan@workwellhealth.com	High
Tina Murphy	Clinic Administrator	Administration	tina.murphy@workwellhealth.com	High
Dr Liam Patel	Physiotherapist	Physiotherapy	liam.patel@workwellhealth.com	High
Emily Roberts	Client (Example Persona)	External	N/A	High
Other Customers (General Client Base)	Patients / Clients	External	N/A	High
Alex Green	IT Support Officer	IT	alex.green@workwellhealth.com	Medium
Practitioner Group	All Practitioners (collective)	Allied Health	N/	
Reception / Casual Assistants	Front Desk / Support Staff	Administration	N/	
Other Executive Leaders	Leadership Team (Operations/Finance/Clinical)	Executive	N/A	Medium

Send to: alex.green...

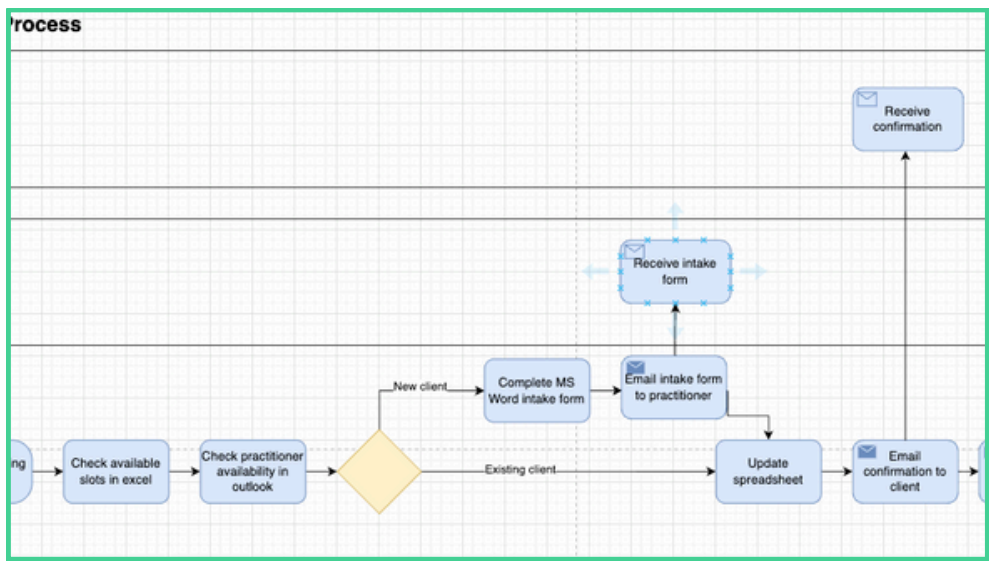
Step 3: Current State Snapshot / Discovery

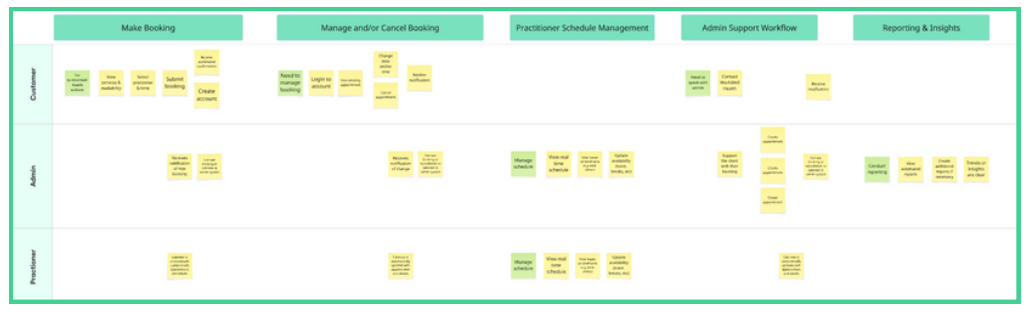
End to end view of the current state situation	too much to list, but some examples: • customer groups (personas/cohorts) • processes / journeys (high level) • systems + channels • known issues / risks • opportunities (high level)
Outcome:	Create a shared baseline of ‘where are we at today’
Deliverables	Current state discovery snapshot

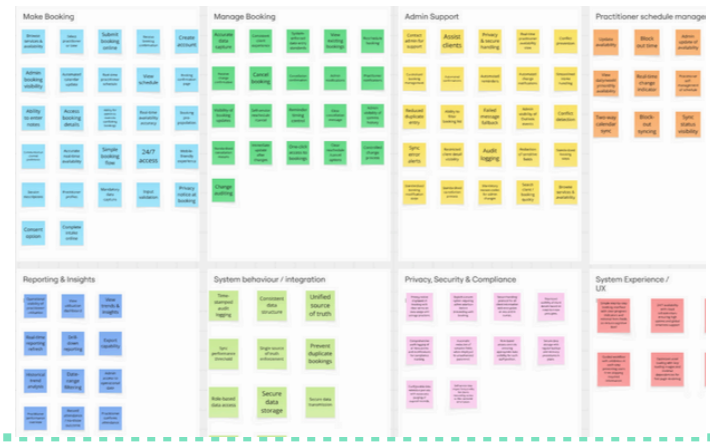
Category	High-level Description	Issues & Opportunities
Customer	- External customers are clients booking physiotherapy, psychology, dietitian - Internal customers include practitioners, reception staff, administrators, ope Clients expect fast, easy booking and flexibility. Internal staff expect accurate	Issues: Long wait times, no after-hours booking, inconsistent communication. Opportunities: Online self-service, automated reminders, streamlined workflows for staff.
Products / Services	- Allied health services delivered through face-to-face appointments. - No digital service delivery components. - Booking and scheduling are core support processes.	Issues: Service delivery is strong, but the booking experience is outdated. Opportunities: Modernise the booking journey to match quality of service.
People	1 clinic with ~20 staff: - practitioners, - admins, - reception, - operations, - IT. - Admin, - reception handle all bookings manually. Practitioners manage their own Outlook calendars. Operations relies on manual reporting.	Issues: Admins overloaded; practitioners lack visibility; operations has no real-time data. Opportunities: Reduce manual workload, improve visibility, free staff for higher-value tasks.
Processes	Key processes include: - making a booking - Manage / modify booking - Practitioner Schedule Management - Handle cancellations and no shows - Reporting and tracking	Issues: Double handling, errors, outdated schedules, delays, inconsistent updates. Opportunities: Automate steps, centralise bookings, reduce rework and errors.
Customer Journey	- Clients book via phone or email during business hours only - No online option - Confirmation is slow, cancellation/reschedule requests require manual handling, reminders are inconsistent.	Issues: Friction, long wait times, inability to book after hours. Opportunities: Improve convenience, speed, accessibility, and overall satisfaction.
Technology, Tools & Templates	- Excel spreadsheet ("Bookings_2025.xlsx"), - Outlook calendars, - Word templates for intake forms, - shared drive storage, - email communication. - No integration or automation.	Issues: Disconnected systems, manual entry errors, version control problems, privacy risks. Opportunities: Introduce a single booking platform with integration and automation.
Reporting	Weekly manual Excel reports compiled by admin for the Operations Manager. No automated dashboards. Limited visibility of utilisation, cancellations, no-shows, or capacity trends.	Issues: Time-consuming, inconsistent, and outdated by the time it's produced. Opportunities: Real-time dashboards and automated reporting.
Regulations & Policies	- Must comply with the Australian Privacy Act 1988. - Client data is currently emailed between staff. - No formal policy framework for data sharing, booking consistency, or system security.	Issues: Potential privacy breaches; no standardised booking process. Opportunities: Embed secure workflows and consistent booking policies within the new system.
Correspondence	- Clients interact via phone and email - Practitioners receive updates via email - Internal updates are mainly email or in-person - No automated messages or SMS reminders.	Issues: Slow, manual, inconsistent. Opportunities: Automated confirmations, reminders, cancellations; reduced admin communication burden.
Governance	- No formal governance for booking processes; decisions are reactive and operational.	Issues: Lack of structure, reliance on individuals, no central authority for process improvement. Opportunities: Introduce formal governance for process ownership and system updates.
Third Party Providers	- No current booking platform vendor. SMS services, online booking tools, or scheduling platforms are not in use.	Issues: Reliance on manual processes only. Opportunities: Engage a SaaS vendor to modernise bookings and scheduling.
Existing risks	- Manual errors, - double bookings, - missed cancellations, - privacy issues with emailed forms, - staff dependency, - inconsistent reporting, - admin burnout.	Issues: Operational inefficiency and client dissatisfaction. Opportunities: Reduce risk through automation and data integrity.
Metrics and KPIs	- average ~200 bookings/week; - 35 admin hours/week spent on bookings; - average ~6% no-show rate; - average ~15% cancellations not rebooked; - average 7 min per booking.	Issues: Manual tracking makes metrics unreliable or outdated. Opportunities: Automated measurement and improved performance visibility.

Step 4: Go Deep Where It Matters

Goal	Based on the Current State Discovery Snapshot, go deeper where needed
Outcome:	More detailed analysis for priority areas... Only deep dive where it adds value
Deliverables	• Business Process Models (current state) • Customer Journey Maps • Data analysis • Domain models / conceptual models (if needed) Note: not everything needs a diagram — only priority areas.







Step 5: Issues, Opportunities, Insights

Goal	Make sense of what you've learned • Pain points • Risks • Opportunities • Observations worth carrying forward
Outcome:	inputs into the problem statement, scope and requirements
Deliverables	Issues, Opportunities & Insights Register

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Step 6: Business Analysis Plan

How will analysis be delivered?	• Discovery approach • Artefacts to be produced • Engagement model • Validation & sign-off approach
Outcome:	aligned expectations before project work ramps up
Deliverables	Business analysis plan

Section	Detail / Content	Notes	Own
1. Purpose	Describe purpose of BA plan	To outline how business analysis activities will be conducted for the initiative. It defines the scope of analysis, the approach, stakeholders, deliverables, timelines, and methods for managing requirements. The plan ensures alignment between the BA, PM, delivery teams, and stakeholders, and provides a shared understanding of how analysis work will be performed, reviewed, and approved.	BA
2. Scope – In-Scope	What areas/processes/systems are included		BA
2. Scope – Out-of-Scope	Exclusions for clarity		BA
3. BA Approach	Agile/Waterfall, iterative/linear, where requirements live, traceability approach		BA
4. Elicitation Approach	Workshops, interviews, observation, artefact review	Sequence can be listed here	BA
5. Stakeholder Engagement	How the BA will interact with stakeholders and cadence	RACI lives in next tab	BA
6. Requirements Structure	BR → SR → FR/NFR → Epics → Stories → UAT mapping		BA
6. Requirements Review & Approval	Who signs off BR/SR/FR and how		PM/I
6. Requirements Prioritisation	MoSCoW, WSJF, etc.		PM/I
7. BA Deliverables	List all deliverables with descriptions	Add columns if needed	BA
8. Timeline & Milestones	Key BA milestones aligned to PM plan	Can reference project plan	BA/I
9. BA Risks & Assumptions	List risks causing analysis blockers, dependencies, assumptions	RAG if helpful	BA
10. Tools & Repositories	Where everything is stored (Confluence, Loop, Miro, etc.)		BA
11. Change Control	How requirements changes are handled		PM/I
12. Communication Plan	How/when BA updates stakeholders		BA

Step 7: Business Requirements

Before solutions...	• What outcomes are required? • What must change? • What constraints apply?
Outcome:	clear, endorsed business intent
Deliverables	Business requirements doc

Requirement ID	Requirement name	Business Requirement	Business driver	Priority
BR-001	Online Booking Access	Clients need the ability to book, reschedule, and cancel appointments online without relying on phone or email.	Reduce admin workload and improve client convenience.	Must
BR-002	Real-Time Schedule Visibility	Staff and practitioners require an accurate, real-time view of practitioner availability and booking changes.	Reduce scheduling errors and improve practitioner efficiency.	Must
BR-003	Reduce Manual Admin Workload	The business needs to reduce administrative effort associated with managing bookings, confirmations, and changes.	Operational efficiency and cost reduction.	Must
BR-004	Automated Client Communications	Appointment confirmations, reminders, and cancellation notifications need to be automated.	Reduce no-shows and manual follow-up effort.	Must
BR-005	Reliable Operational Reporting	Management requires timely reporting on utilisation, cancellations, and no-show trends.	Improve operational insight and decision-making.	Must
BR-006	Calendar Integration	The booking system must integrate with Outlook 365 to maintain a single, accurate practitioner schedule.	Prevent double bookings and ensure availability alignment.	Must
BR-007	Improve Client Booking Experience	Clients need a faster, simpler, and more accessible booking experience, including after-hours access.	Increase client satisfaction and reduce friction.	Should
BR-008	Reduce Booking Errors	The business requires a controlled and consistent scheduling process to reduce errors from manual spreadsheets.	Quality and accuracy of booking data.	Must
BR-009	Data Privacy & Compliance	Client information must be managed in alignment with the Australian Privacy Act 1988.	Legal compliance and risk reduction.	Should
BR-010	Standardised Booking Workflow	Booking processes must be consistent across reception and administrative staff to reduce variation and reliance on individuals.	Process consistency and reliability.	Should

Step 8: Validate & Get Endorsement

Pause before moving on	• Present findings and artefacts • Validate assumptions • Get agreement to proceed Note - don’t wait until the end to involve stakeholders, they would have been involved in all previous steps! This is just the final validation / presentation.
Outcome:	confidence to move into design & delivery
Deliverables	Presentations (e.g. slides summarising your work)

We have templates, processes, and frameworks for all of these activities...

Including all other phases of the project lifecycle....

Want them, **join our mentoring platform.**



Matthew Thomas
The BA Mentor